

Decoding the Business - Equity Research Report

- Crizac Limited

360°

RESEARCH VIEW

A sequenced research pack with a three-page executive summary followed by detailed reports numbered 1, 2, 3, 3.1, 4, 5 and 6. Each section includes visible page numbering and preserves the original standalone report formatting.

Prepared: 04 July 2026

Executive Summary: 3 pages

Detailed Reports: 7

Total Pages: 10

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Core Business Thesis

Crizac is an asset-light B2B international student recruitment platform connecting students, agents and global higher-education institutions. Its business is recruitment infrastructure, application processing, student matching and enrolment-linked monetisation, not university teaching.

The industry remains structurally attractive, but the near-term environment has shifted from simple volume growth to compliance-led growth.

Current Market Signal

UK remains a large corridor, while Germany, France and Ireland provide meaningful Europe ex-UK diversification. Policy, visa quality, and destination mix matter more than raw application growth.

Crizac's opportunity is strongest where it can redirect demand across destinations and improve quality screening.

AREA	CURRENT REPORT VIEW	INVESTMENT READ-THROUGH
Industry	International student mobility remains structurally attractive, but regulated and policy-sensitive.	Attractive sector, but destination policy can change conversion quickly.
Business Model	B2B platform linking agents and universities; revenue is linked to successful student recruitment/enrolment.	Capital-light model with network effects if conversion and institution trust stay strong.
BCG View	Core B2B platform is a Star; UK-led mature relationships act like a Cash Cow; AI/B2C/geographic additions are Question Marks.	Use core cash generation to diversify, but avoid low-quality application volume.
Product Life Cycle	Overall business is in growth stage, while established UK corridor is more mature and compliance-led.	Future returns depend on quality growth, not only more agents/applications.

Financial and Operational Quality Summary

Concise summary page 2 of 3, prepared before the detailed numbered reports.

FY26 REVENUE

Rs 1,042.2 cr

Up 22.7% YoY

FY26 EBITDA

Rs 282.4 cr

Margin 27.1%

ROCE

High

~42.9% derived; 48.6% IP basis

DEBT / EQUITY

Near zero

Borrowings are immaterial

What Is Working

- Revenue, EBITDA and PAT scaled in FY26 with improved EBITDA margin.
- Capital-light model produced strong returns with almost no debt.
- Free cash flow remained positive after capex.
- Applications processed increased to 3.94 lakh and active agents reached 5,389.
- Revenue per enrolment improved to about Rs 4.22 lakh.

What Needs Proof

- Applications grew much faster than enrolments.
- Enrolments per active agent weakened.
- Operating cash flow was positive but lower than FY25 despite higher profit.
- Receivable and payable discipline must remain strong as revenue grows.
- Acquisition-linked goodwill and other current financial assets need tracking.

KPI	LATEST REPORT FIGURE	INTERPRETATION
Applications	3.94 lakh in FY26, up 43% YoY	Top-of-funnel scale is strong.
Enrolments	24,697 in FY26, up 13.8% YoY	Enrolments grew slower than applications.
Conversion	Analytical application-to-enrolment ratio fell from 7.9% to 6.3%	Most important operating-quality concern.
Receivable Days	Improved to 83.5 days from 110.2	Cash discipline improved, but needs continued proof.

By CA Padarabind Pradhan, Research Analyst.
Content is for Educational Purpose

Promoter, Management, Risks and Monitorables Summary

Concise summary page 3 of 3, prepared before the detailed numbered reports.

Promoter and Management Read

The promoter and management assessment should be read with the business model: Crizac’s strength depends on institution relationships, agent governance, destination strategy and disciplined cash conversion.

The IPO being a pure offer for sale means the thesis should be built around organic cash generation and execution durability rather than fresh-capital deployment.

Key Risks, Concerns and Watchpoints

- Visa and destination-country policy risk.
- University concentration and bargaining power of top institutional partners.
- Non-exclusive agents and potential agent-productivity dilution.
- Low-quality application volume hurting conversion, reputation and collections.
- Data, documentation, compliance and student-outcome risks.

MONITORABLE	GOOD SIGNAL	WEAK SIGNAL
Application-to-enrolment conversion	Improves from FY26 level and validates application growth.	Continues declining despite application and agent additions.
Revenue per enrolment	Stays near or above Rs 4.22 lakh without receivable stretch.	Falls, or improves only because collections slow down.
Agent productivity	Enrolments per active agent recover toward FY25 level.	New agents add applications but not genuine enrolments.
Working capital	Receivable days stay near 83.5 or improve.	Receivables grow faster than revenue and enrolments.
Destination diversification	Europe and other corridors reduce single-destination risk.	Business remains too dependent on policy-sensitive corridors.

Overall view: Crizac is a credible high-return platform with strong FY26 execution, but the fresh-purchase thesis depends on conversion quality, cash conversion, university relationship durability, and destination diversification.

By **CA Padarabind Pradhan, Research Analyst.**
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DETAILED REPORT BEGINS

Full section-wise analysis follows after the executive summary

1. Industry and Value Chain Overview

INDUSTRY AND VALUE CHAIN

Crizac Limited - International Student Mobility Industry Overview

Industry structure, value chain, policy environment, competitive forces, and Crizac's position in the student recruitment ecosystem. Current public status verified on 03 July 2026, with UK and continental Europe shown separately.

Current Verification: 03 July 2026

Industry: International Student Mobility

Scope: Industry + Value Chain

Company Context: Crizac

Current Industry View

Historical data is used only to explain the present industry structure.

Industry thesis

The international student mobility industry remains structurally attractive because demand for foreign degrees, migration optionality, employability, and global exposure is still strong. The industry has, however, moved from a pure volume-growth phase into a compliance-led phase where destination governments are actively managing inflows, visa quality, post-study work rights, and agent conduct.

Value-chain implication

The durable players should be those that can source genuine students, manage agents, improve conversion, maintain university trust, and redirect demand when policy shifts across UK, Canada, Australia, U.S., Ireland, Germany, and New Zealand corridors.

Current Market Signals - Global, UK and Europe

Public web verification layer plus company disclosure. New UK and continental-Europe numbers are shown alongside the earlier U.S., Canada, Australia, and Crizac signals.

GLOBAL MOBILE STUDENTS

7.3m+

IIE Project Atlas / UNESCO-linked data indicate more than 7.3 million internationally mobile students globally in 2023.

U.S. INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS

1.18m

Open Doors shows 1,177,766 international students at U.S. colleges and universities.

CANADA STUDY PERMITS

437k

Canada announced 437,000 study permits for 2025 and stabilisation at that level for 2026.

AUSTRALIA 2026 INTAKE CONTROL

295k

Current reporting states Australia has a 2026 planning level near 295,000 new international enrolments.

UK ENROLLED INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS

6.86L

HESA 2024/25: 685,565 non-UK students, down 6.1% from 729,850 in 2023/24.

UK SPONSORED STUDY VISAS

4.10L

Home Office YE March 2026: 409,954 sponsored-study visa grants, including 391,572 main applicants.

EUROPE EX-UK TRACKED MARKETS

8.77L+

Germany about 420k, France 412,087, Ireland 44,535. This is a verified floor, not total Europe.

CRIZAC FY26 APPLICATIONS

3.94L

Concall says 3.94 lakh applications processed across 85+ source countries and 8 destination countries.

MARKET	LATEST VERIFIED NUMBER	DIRECTION	SIGNAL FOR CRIZAC
United States	1,177,766 international students.	Large but policy-sensitive	Brand pull remains strong, but visa timing and political risk can affect conversion.

MARKET	LATEST VERIFIED NUMBER	DIRECTION	SIGNAL FOR CRIZAC
Canada	437,000 study permits for 2025, with 2026 stabilised around the same level.	Managed volume	Good quality cohorts can still work, but weaker segments face tighter caps and PGWP alignment pressure.
Australia	2026 planning level near 295,000 new international enrolments.	Controlled intake	Higher compliance and student-cost sensitivity raise the value of screening and course fit.
United Kingdom	685,565 international HE students in 2024/25; 409,954 sponsored-study visas in YE March 2026.	Large but tighter	UK remains a large monetisable corridor, but volume quality, genuine-student screening, sponsor compliance, and graduate-route economics matter more than raw application volume.
Continental Europe - Germany	About 420,000 international students and doctoral candidates in winter semester 2025/26 per DAAD current reporting.	Growing	Germany is a diversification destination when English-speaking markets tighten, but language, documentation, and course-fit capability become important.
Continental Europe - France	412,087 international students in 2023/24; France continues to target higher inbound internationalisation.	Large / stable	France adds scale to the Europe opportunity, especially where affordability and European degree value attract non-Anglophone demand.
Continental Europe - Ireland	44,535 non-Irish domiciled enrolments in publicly funded HEIs in 2024/25, including 32,940 non-EU enrolments.	Growing	Ireland is smaller than UK/Germany/France but strategically relevant because it is English-speaking, EU-based, and up 10.2% YoY.
Crizac operating signal	FY26: 3.94 lakh applications processed across 85+ source countries and 8 destination countries.	Platform scale	The market signal supports destination diversification. The key KPI is not applications alone; it is conversion into compliant enrolments.

Industry Definition

Crizac operates in student recruitment infrastructure, not in university teaching itself.

What the industry does

- Generates and qualifies overseas education demand.
- Connects students, local agents, and global universities.
- Manages applications, offers, documentation, visa readiness, and enrolment follow-through.
- May add financing, counselling, accommodation, insurance, forex, and immigration services.

What the industry is not

- It is not the university education provider.
- It is not only digital advertising or lead generation.
- It is not policy-proof; visa rules are central to conversion.
- It is not always direct-to-student because many models are B2B through agents.

Why platforms exist

- Universities need diversified student pipelines.
- Local agents need access to multiple institutions and programs.
- Students need course discovery and documentation support.
- Platforms reduce friction and give universities better funnel visibility.

Industry Value Chain

The student journey is long. Revenue is usually earned only when an application converts into enrolment.

1

Demand Creation

Students and parents evaluate foreign education based on degree value, career outcomes, migration optionality, affordability, peer influence, and country reputation.

2

Lead Sourcing

Local agents, counsellors, digital platforms, school networks, fairs, alumni, and social media identify and qualify prospective students.

3

Counselling and Matching

Student profile, budget, academic eligibility, English tests, destination preference, work-right expectations, and visa suitability are matched to programs.

4

Application Processing

Documents, applications, SOPs, references, financial proof, and university-specific requirements are

prepared and submitted through agent or platform workflows.

5

Admissions Decision

Universities review eligibility, issue conditional or unconditional offers, and start compliance checks for genuine student quality.

6

Visa and Compliance

Students prove funds, intent, language ability, identity, health, and other requirements. This is where policy changes most directly affect conversion.

7

Ancillary Services

Loans, forex, remittance, insurance, accommodation, flights, pre-departure support, immigration advice, and job-readiness products attach to the core journey.

8

Enrolment

The student accepts, pays, receives visa approval, arrives or starts study, and becomes counted as an enrolled student by the institution.

9

Commission and Revenue

Universities typically pay recruitment commissions after verified enrolment or tuition milestones. Aggregators may share commission with local agents.

10

Post-Enrolment Loop

Student outcomes, visa success, refunds, retention, and alumni references feed back into agent reputation, university trust, and future conversion.

Crizac's disclosed position is mainly across steps 2 to 9: agent network, university partnerships, platform processing, application tracking, conversion, and enrolment-linked revenue.

Where Value Is Captured

The most valuable points are where information, compliance, and conversion risk are highest.

PARTICIPANT	ROLE	HOW VALUE IS CAPTURED	KEY RISK
Universities / institutions	Offer programs, issue admissions, receive tuition, manage compliance.	International tuition revenue, campus diversity, ranking and reputation benefits.	Visa policy, agent quality, student retention, government scrutiny.
Local agents / counsellors	Source students, guide choices, collect documents, support conversion.	Commission share, counselling fees, ancillary product commissions.	Mis-selling, low-quality applications, fragmented compliance.
Aggregators / platforms	Connect agents with institutions; standardise	University commission, platform scale, data,	University concentration, agent churn,

PARTICIPANT	ROLE	HOW VALUE IS CAPTURED	KEY RISK
	workflows; track applications.	conversion analytics, ancillary integrations.	disintermediation, data-security risk.
Students / parents	Pay tuition and living cost; bear visa and employment outcome risk.	Degree, employability, international exposure, post-study optionality.	High cost, visa rejection, weak job outcomes, misinformation.
Financing and services providers	Loans, forex, insurance, accommodation, visa, travel, remittance.	Interest income, fees, referral commissions, cross-sell.	Credit risk, regulatory risk, poor student outcomes.

Destination-Country Environment

Destination policy determines conversion more than raw student interest.

DESTINATION	CURRENT DIRECTION	WHAT CHANGED	IMPACT ON AGENTS/PLATFORMS	CRIZAC RELEVANCE
United Kingdom	Major destination, but policy direction is tighter and sponsor quality is more important.	HESA 2024/25 shows 685,565 international students, down 6.1% YoY. Home Office YE March 2026 shows 409,954 sponsored-study visa grants, down 3% YoY and 37% below the YE June 2023 peak.	Higher need for genuine-student screening, institution quality, conversion discipline, and careful nationality/course-level mix.	High relevance because Crizac has historically been strong in UK recruitment.
Canada	Managed-volume market.	IRCC announced caps and PGWP alignment with labour-market needs; 2025 permits reduced to 437,000 and 2026 stabilised at that level.	Lower volume opportunity in weaker segments; better prospects for high-quality eligible cohorts.	Relevant as a destination but riskier than the older high-growth period.
Australia	Quality and integrity-led market with managed commencements.	Current reporting points to a 2026 planning level around 295,000 and higher student visa application	Agents need better compliance; high costs can slow student decisions and reduce marginal demand.	Relevant if students are placed into compliant, high-quality institutions.

DESTINATION	CURRENT DIRECTION	WHAT CHANGED	IMPACT ON AGENTS/PLATFORMS	CRIZAC RELEVANCE
		cost from July 2026.		
United States	Large but policy-sensitive market.	Open Doors shows a large international student base, while recent reporting indicates visa uncertainty and weaker new-enrolment momentum.	Strong brand pull, but visa timing and political risk affect conversion.	Potential diversification market, but not a risk-free growth corridor.
Continental Europe - Germany, France, Ireland	Clear diversification opportunity, not a single homogeneous market.	Germany is currently around 420k international students; France reported 412,087 in 2023/24; Ireland reported 44,535 in 2024/25 and 10.2% YoY growth.	Platforms need country-specific counselling, language/course-fit filters, documentation quality, and visa-rule tracking.	Important for reducing reliance on UK/Canada-style corridors and for using Crizac's 85+ source-country network.
New Zealand and other alternatives	Potential beneficiaries of redirection.	Crizac management highlighted demand redirection toward UK, Ireland, Germany, New Zealand and other markets when Canada/U.S. tighten.	Platforms with multi-destination relationships can redirect demand faster than single-country agents.	Useful as smaller but higher-quality diversification corridors.

Competitive Structure

The market is fragmented at sourcing level, but trust and institution relationships create scale advantages.

Competitor types

- Local education agents and counsellors.
- Digital course-search and application platforms.
- Large agency networks and international offices.
- University direct recruitment teams.
- Pathway, foundation, and transnational education providers.

Sources of moat

- Large verified agent network.
- Deep university relationships and contract history.
- High-quality application screening and conversion analytics.
- Destination and source-country diversification.
- Technology workflow integrated with admissions processes.

Threats to moat

- Universities reducing commission or going direct.
- Policy caps reducing available seats.
- Bad-agent behaviour harming the sector.
- Low-cost digital platforms commoditising lead flow.
- Data-security or student-documentation failures.

Crizac's Industry Position

Company context is included only to show where Crizac sits in the value chain.

INDUSTRY FACTOR	CRIZAC DISCLOSED POSITION	INTERPRETATION
Business model	B2B education platform for agents and global institutions of higher education.	Crizac is a recruitment infrastructure/platform business, not a university operator.
Network	Q4 FY26 call states platform connects over 15,000 global agents and more than 400 partner universities; active agents were 5,389.	Scale is a potential advantage if agent quality and university trust remain strong.
Application processing	Q4 FY26 call states 3.94 lakh applications processed during FY26 across 85+ source countries and 8 destination countries.	Application volume is high, but the key industry metric is conversion into genuine enrolments.
Conversion	Management said overall conversion was around 14%, with India around 10%, China/LATAM around 20%, and Africa around 5%.	Geography mix affects revenue quality and predictability; expansion into higher-conversion source markets is strategically important.

INDUSTRY FACTOR	CRIZAC DISCLOSED POSITION	INTERPRETATION
Customer concentration	Management said top 10 university partners accounted for 66% of revenue.	Trust with top universities is a moat, but concentration is also a bargaining and renewal risk.
Strategic expansion	FY26 actions included StudiesPlanet in LATAM, Global Tree for B2C counselling/immigration, EduMentor AI, and New Zealand operations.	Crizac is trying to move from pure B2B aggregation toward more integrated student-mobility services.

Industry Growth Drivers

These are structural drivers, not company-specific financial forecasts.

Demand-side drivers

- Rising middle-class aspiration in India, Asia, Africa, and LATAM.
- Limited seats and intense competition in domestic higher education.
- Global employability and migration optionality.
- Family preference for English-taught international qualifications.
- Digital discovery and social proof making overseas study easier to consider.

Supply-side drivers

- Universities need international student revenue and diversification.
- Institutions prefer distribution partners in fragmented source markets.
- Technology lowers the cost of processing large application funnels.
- Ancillary services increase lifetime value per student.
- New destinations can absorb redirected demand when traditional markets tighten.

Key Industry Risks

These risks directly affect the value chain and conversion economics.

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	WHO IS MOST EXPOSED	WHAT TO MONITOR
Visa policy risk	Caps, higher fees, stricter proof-of-funds, and post-study work changes can reduce conversion.	Single-country agents, low-quality providers, students needing migration pathways.	UK, Canada, Australia, U.S. policy updates and visa grant/rejection trends.
Agent conduct risk	Mis-selling damages student outcomes and can invite regulatory scrutiny.	Fragmented local agents and aggregators without strong screening.	Agent commission rules, complaints, refund rates, visa refusals.
University concentration	Revenue can depend heavily on a few institutions and courses.	Platforms with top-university concentration.	Top partner revenue share, contract renewals, institution ranking and quality.
Disintermediation	Universities can build direct channels or use competing platforms.	Agents/platforms with weak data or weak student service.	Direct admissions push, commission cuts, preferred partner lists.
Data and compliance risk	Student documents, identity, finances, and personal data are sensitive.	Technology platforms processing large application volumes.	Cybersecurity, data privacy, application fraud controls, audit trails.

Industry Attractiveness

Assessment from a present industry-analysis lens.

Attractive features

- Large addressable market with long-term student aspiration.
- Fragmented sourcing creates aggregator opportunity.
- University relationships can create repeat business.
- Data and workflow technology can improve conversion and compliance.

Mixed features

- Scale matters, but quality matters more under tighter visa rules.
- Policy tightening can redirect demand rather than destroy it.
- Ancillary services add upside but also operational complexity.
- High-growth markets can become regulated quickly.

Unattractive features

- Low control over destination-country visa decisions.
- Reputation risk from bad agents and student exploitation.
- Revenue timing depends on application-to-enrolment conversion.
- University concentration can reduce pricing power.

TAM - Target Addressable Market

TAM is defined for Crizac's operating segment: overseas education recruitment and student mobility services, not the entire education sector.

MARKET LAYER	ADDRESSABLE POOL	RELEVANCE FOR CRIZAC-LIKE PLATFORMS
Broad education market	Crizac's offer document cites global education market size of about USD 6 trillion in 2024, projected to around USD 7.4 trillion by 2030.	This is the broadest backdrop but too wide for direct TAM. It includes education segments far beyond international recruitment.
International student mobility TAM	IIE/Project Atlas data indicates more than 7.3 million internationally mobile students globally in 2023.	This is the realistic demand universe for cross-border higher education services.
UK serviceable pool	HESA 2024/25: 685,565 international students in UK higher education; Home Office YE March 2026: 409,954 sponsored-study visa grants.	UK remains large, but the direction is quality-screened and policy-managed rather than pure volume growth.
Continental Europe serviceable pool	Verified tracked-market floor of about 8.77 lakh students from Germany, France, and Ireland alone; broader Europe is larger once Netherlands, Spain, Italy, Nordics, and other destinations are added.	Europe ex-UK is a meaningful diversification pool, but it requires more destination-specific matching than the UK corridor.
India outbound TAM	Crizac's F&S-backed DRHP disclosure estimated about 14.8 lakh Indian students abroad in 2023 and 25 lakh by 2030.	India remains a major source market, but Crizac's future TAM is broader because it now sources from 85+ countries.
Serviceable market for platforms	Students applying through agents, counsellors, digital platforms, and university partner networks.	This is the most relevant opportunity. Revenue is usually commission-linked and depends on enrolment conversion, not only application volume.

MARKET LAYER	ADDRESSABLE POOL	RELEVANCE FOR CRIZAC-LIKE PLATFORMS
Crizac's current operating reach	Q4 FY26 call: 3.94 lakh applications processed, 5,389 active agents, 400+ universities, 85+ source countries, and 8 destination countries.	Crizac is already addressing a multi-country TAM, with the main opportunity in increasing conversion and destination breadth.

Industry Growth Rate

Growth should be read through student mobility volume, source-country expansion, destination policy, and conversion rates.

Long-term growth - Crizac DRHP cites Indian students abroad expected to grow from about 14.8 lakh in 2023 to 25 lakh by 2030, implying 7.8% CAGR. - Global student mobility continues to expand over the long term, supported by employability and migration optionality.
Near-term moderation - Canada, UK, Australia, and U.S. policy tightening can slow conversion in specific corridors. - Growth is shifting from simple volume growth to quality-screened, destination-diversified growth.
Crizac indicator - FY26 call: applications grew 43% YoY and enrolments grew 14% YoY. - This gap shows why conversion quality matters more than raw application growth.

Sector Classification

The business sits across education services, edtech, and migration-linked student mobility.

QUESTION	ASSESSMENT	REASONING
Sector	Education services / EdTech / International student mobility.	The core function is connecting students, agents, and universities through a technology-enabled recruitment platform.

QUESTION	ASSESSMENT	REASONING
Futuristic sector?	Yes, but regulation-sensitive.	Global education, AI-based matching, digital application workflows, financing, visa support, and cross-border student services are long-duration themes. Policy risk keeps the sector cyclical by destination.
Product nature	Semi-discretionary, high-commitment service.	Overseas education is not a daily necessity, but for aspirational families it behaves like a strategic life investment. Demand is resilient among serious students, but price, visa rules, and job outlook affect timing.
Revenue nature	Conversion-linked service revenue.	Value is realised when applications convert into admissions/enrolments and universities pay recruitment commissions or service fees.

Value Chain Analysis - Functional View

Mapped to the requested inward, operation, marketing and sales, outward, and after-sale service format.

VALUE-CHAIN STAGE	INDUSTRY ACTIVITY	KEY SUCCESS FACTORS	CRIZAC RELEVANCE
Inward	University contracts, agent onboarding, destination program database, student leads, eligibility rules, visa-policy intelligence, and document intake.	Quality of university relationships, verified agent base, updated course/visa data, and student-source diversification.	Crizac has disclosed 400+ university partners, 15,000+ global agents, and sourcing across 85+ countries.
Operations	Profile screening, course matching, application submission, document validation, offer tracking, compliance checks, and conversion monitoring.	Fast processing, low error rate, genuine-student screening, technology workflow, and university trust.	Crizac's platform processed 3.94 lakh applications in FY26; conversion quality is central.
Marketing and Sales	Agent activation, student counselling, education fairs, digital campaigns, university promotion, course awareness, and destination positioning.	Agent productivity, brand trust, multi-country reach, and ability to explain visa/work-right changes.	Crizac's B2B model depends on agents; acquisitions add LATAM, B2C counselling, AI matching, and product/marketing depth.
Outward	Offer acceptance, tuition deposit, visa support, enrolment confirmation, university reporting,	Visa approval, timely enrolment, accurate reporting, commission	Revenue recognition is linked to enrolments; Q3 applications converting into Q4 revenue

VALUE-CHAIN STAGE	INDUSTRY ACTIVITY	KEY SUCCESS FACTORS	CRIZAC RELEVANCE
	commission invoicing, and agent commission sharing.	reconciliation, and low refund/cancellation risk.	shows outward timing importance.
After-sale services	Pre-departure support, accommodation, insurance, forex, loans, student support, issue resolution, retention, and alumni referrals.	Student satisfaction, retention, post-arrival support, and cross-sell quality.	Global Tree, EduMentor AI, ForeignAdmits/Edument, and product-led additions indicate movement into broader lifecycle services.

Major Players - Indian and Global

Representative players across recruitment, counselling, pathway, and student-mobility platforms.

CATEGORY	INDIAN / INDIA-FACING PLAYERS	GLOBAL PLAYERS	COMPETITIVE NOTE
Student recruitment platforms / aggregators	Crizac, Leverage Edu, Leap Scholar, Yocket, Edvoy, upGrad Abroad, KC Overseas, GeeBee.	ApplyBoard, IDP Education, AECC, SI-UK, Studyporals, Keystone Education Group.	Competition is based on agent network, university partnerships, destination breadth, student trust, and conversion quality.
Pathway and university partnership operators	India-facing partnerships operated by global groups.	Navitas, INTO University Partnerships, Study Group, Shorelight, Kaplan International Pathways, Global University Systems.	These players can compete for university relationships and student pipelines, but many operate deeper in pathway/program delivery.
Direct university channels	University India offices, direct representatives, alumni networks, school/counsellor partnerships.	University international recruitment offices and country managers.	Direct recruitment is both a substitute and a channel partner depending on institution strategy.
Ancillary service players	Education loan NBFCs/banks, forex providers, visa consultants, accommodation and insurance partners.	Global student finance, remittance, accommodation, and insurance platforms.	Ancillary players can increase lifetime value or become bundled competitors.

Porter's Five Forces

Assessment for the international student recruitment and mobility platform industry.

FORCE	INTENSITY	ANALYSIS	INVESTMENT IMPLICATION
Substitute product	Medium	Substitutes include domestic higher education, online degrees, transnational education, direct university applications, pathway programs, and migration routes not linked to study.	Overseas education has strong aspiration value, but students can defer, switch destinations, or choose domestic/online alternatives when costs or visa risk rise.
Rivalry among competitors	High	The sourcing layer is fragmented and competitive. Platforms, agents, counsellors, and university direct teams compete for the same students and institutions.	Scale alone is insufficient; conversion quality, trust, compliance, and university depth differentiate winners.
Bargaining power of buyers	Medium-High	There are two buyer groups: universities paying commissions and students/families choosing counsellors or destinations. Universities can negotiate commissions; students compare alternatives.	Platforms need demonstrated quality and conversion to defend economics.
Bargaining power of suppliers	Medium-High	Suppliers include universities, agents, counsellors, and destination-policy gatekeepers. Top universities and productive agents have bargaining power.	University concentration and agent productivity are critical monitorables.
Threat of new entrants / entry barriers	Medium	Basic counselling or lead generation has low entry barriers. Scaled platforms with university contracts, compliance systems, agent networks, data, and multi-country operations have higher barriers.	Entry barriers exist at scale, not at the local-agent level. Moat must be proven through relationships, data, compliance, and conversion.

Price Sensitivity

Price sensitivity is assessed from the student/family side and the university/commission side.

Student-side sensitivity

- High total cost makes the product price-sensitive at the margin: tuition, living cost, visa fees, forex, travel, insurance, and financing cost all matter.

- Serious students are less sensitive if the destination has strong post-study work rights and job outcomes.
- Emerging-market students are more affected by currency depreciation and higher visa/proof-of-funds requirements.
- Students may switch destination rather than abandon the overseas education plan completely.

University/platform sensitivity

- Universities are sensitive to commission quality: they will pay for genuine enrolments but resist low-quality or high-refund channels.
- Platforms face commission pressure if universities can recruit directly or use competing aggregators.
- Agent commission sharing can become competitive in fragmented markets.
- Policy tightening increases value of quality screening, which can reduce pure price competition for trusted platforms.

Overall view: Overseas education is semi-discretionary and high-ticket. Demand is aspirational, but conversion is price-sensitive. The industry is less sensitive to small counselling fees and more sensitive to total landed cost, visa certainty, work rights, and perceived employment outcomes.

Bottom Line

Industry-overview conclusion.

Current industry verdict: The international student mobility industry remains structurally attractive, but the easy volume-growth phase is over. The industry is now being reshaped by tighter visa policy, higher compliance expectations, destination caps, student affordability pressure, and scrutiny of agent conduct.

For companies like Crizac, the opportunity is in being a trusted compliance-and-conversion platform between agents and universities. The risk is that the same value chain is exposed to policy shocks, university concentration, and agent-quality problems. The most important industry monitorables are visa rules, destination diversification, student conversion quality, university partner concentration, and the ability to add services such as counselling, AI matching, finance, visa support, and post-arrival assistance without weakening compliance.

Sources Checked

Public sources checked on 03 July 2026, plus local company documents.

- [IIE Project Atlas](#) and [Explore Global Data](#): global student mobility data initiative and 2025 data-download/infographic reference.

- [UK Home Office, Why do people come to the UK? Study](#): YE March 2026 sponsored-study visa grants, main applicants, dependant grants, course-level mix, and policy context.
- [HESA, Where do HE students come from?](#): UK 2024/25 non-UK higher-education student enrolment dataset, cross-checked via Home Office reference to HESA's January 2026 release.
- [DAAD](#): Germany international student current reporting and winter-semester 2025/26 market signal.
- [Campus France](#): France international-student market size and internationalisation policy context.
- [Higher Education Authority, Ireland](#): 2024/25 non-Irish domiciled and non-EU enrolment statistics.
- [IIE Open Doors](#): U.S. international student data, including 1,177,766 international students.
- [Government of Canada, IRCC](#): study permit cap and PGWP policy direction.
- [UK Home Office White Paper](#): migration control, student-route quality, and graduate-route policy direction.
- [Australian Department of Home Affairs](#): student visa page, last updated 1 July 2026.
- [The Australian, 3 July 2026](#): current reporting on Australia 2026 intake level and visa fee changes.
- Local research folder: Crizac DRHP/prospectus and Q4 FY26 investor concall transcript for company-specific value-chain position.

Prepared as of 03 July 2026. Scope is limited to industry and value-chain overview for Crizac's operating segment.

2. Company Analysis

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COMPANY ANALYSIS

Crizac Limited - Strong Asset-Light Platform, But Conversion Quality Is The Key Test

Latest company KPI review, BCG positioning, product life-cycle stage, competitive assessment, differentiation, cost advantage, focus, and value-shop analysis. Current status checked on 03 July 2026; financial and operating numbers use FY26 company filing/concall data available in the workspace.

Current Verification: 03 July 2026

Company: Crizac Limited

Listed: NSE Symbol CRIZAC

Company Filing Data Only

Executive View

This is a business-quality view, not valuation or investment advice.

What looks strong now

Crizac has a capital-light international student recruitment platform with FY26 revenue of Rs 1,042.2 crore, EBITDA of Rs 282.4 crore, EBITDA margin of 27.1%, near-zero debt, and positive free cash flow after capex. The operating network also scaled: applications reached 3.94 lakh and active agents reached 5,389.

What must be proven next

The main test is not whether the company can add applications or agents. The test is whether those applications convert into genuine enrolments without stretching receivables, weakening university trust, or becoming too dependent on one destination or a few university partners.

Latest Operational and Financial KPIs

FY26 consolidated values. ROCE, D/E, and FCF are derived from filing numbers and shown with calculation basis.

REVENUE

Rs 1,042.2 cr

FY26 revenue from operations, up 22.7% YoY.

EBITDA

Rs 282.4 cr

FY26 EBITDA, up about 32.7% YoY.

EBITDA MARGIN

27.1%

Improved from 25.1% in FY25.

ROCE

~42.9%

Derived using EBIT / closing capital employed.

DEBT / EQUITY

~0.003x

Borrowings of about Rs 1.75 cr vs equity of Rs 592.4 cr.

FREE CASH FLOW

Rs 127.2 cr

CFO Rs 144.1 cr less capex/intangibles Rs 16.9 cr.

APPLICATIONS

3.94L

394,629 applications processed in FY26, up 43% YoY.

ACTIVE AGENTS

5,389

Active agents up 36.5% YoY.

ENROLMENTS

24,697

FY26 enrolments, up 13.8% YoY.

REVENUE / ENROLMENT

Rs 4.22L

Approximate FY26 realisation per enrolled student.

KPI	FY26	CALCULATION / BASIS	INTERPRETATION
ROCE	~42.9%	EBIT Rs 255.1 cr / closing capital employed Rs 594.3 cr. EBIT is EBITDA less depreciation and amortisation.	Strong High return profile is supported by an asset-light model and low debt.
Debt to equity ratio	~0.003x	Total borrowings about Rs 1.75 cr / total equity Rs 592.4 cr.	Very low leverage Balance sheet risk from debt is minimal.
EBITDA margin	27.1%	EBITDA Rs 282.4 cr / revenue Rs 1,042.2 cr.	Healthy Cost of services ratio improved and operating leverage is visible.
Free cash flow	Rs 127.2 cr	Operating cash flow Rs 144.1 cr less capex/intangibles Rs 16.9 cr. After acquisitions/investments of Rs 25.5 cr, cash generation is still about Rs 101.7 cr.	Positive Cash generation remains positive despite working-capital reversal and expansion activity.
Receivable days	83.5 days	Company-method estimate from financial statements.	Improved Better than FY25's 110.2 days, but still a key monitorable.

BCG Matrix

BCG view is analytical, not disclosed by the company. It maps Crizac's business lines and strategic options.

Low relative strength / emerging proof	High relative strength / monetised position
● Question Mark B2C counselling, AI tools, LATAM expansion, New Zealand and ancillary services.	● Star Core B2B international student recruitment platform.

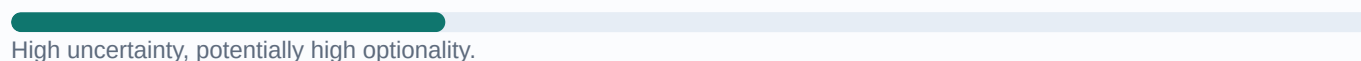
High market growth	These can increase lifetime value and diversification, but the market share, economics, and repeatable conversion are not yet fully proven in public data.	Revenue, EBITDA, applications, active agents, and institution count are all scaling. The platform is in a growth market and has visible network depth.
Low / mature growth	● Dog Low-quality application volume and weak-conversion source pools. Applications that do not convert into genuine enrolments consume processing capacity and can damage university trust. This is the area to avoid, not to grow.	● Cash Cow Established UK-led university relationships and repeat agent network. The UK corridor remains large and monetisable, but policy tightening makes it more mature and compliance-led. It should fund diversification rather than be the only growth engine.

Product Life-Cycle Stage

Different parts of the business are at different stages.

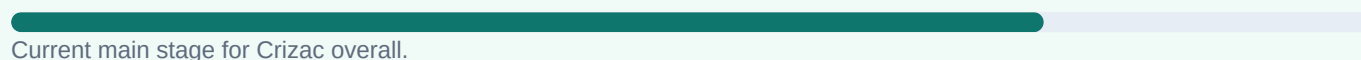
Introduction

AI matching, B2C counselling additions, and newer destination expansions.



Growth

Core agent-university platform and multi-country application engine.



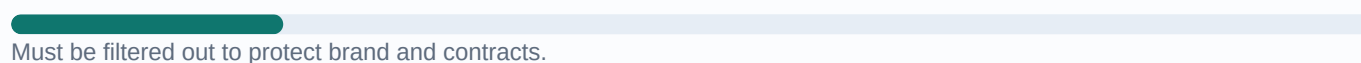
Maturity

UK-heavy recruitment corridor and established university contracts.



Decline / Avoid

Low-quality, low-conversion applications and non-compliant agent behaviour.



Overall classification: Crizac is in the **growth stage**, but not the early easy-growth stage. The next phase is compliance-led growth: conversion, visa quality, university trust, and receivable discipline matter more than raw application volume.

Competitive Analysis

Competitive set includes global recruitment platforms, education agents, direct university channels, and Indian outbound education platforms.

FACTOR	CRIZAC POSITION	COMPETITOR PRESSURE	CURRENT ASSESSMENT
Scale and network	15,000+ broader agents, 5,389 active agents, 400+ university partners, 85+ source countries, 8 destination countries.	ApplyBoard, IDP, AECC, SI-UK, Leverage Edu, Leap Scholar, Yocket, KC Overseas and local agents compete for the same student pools.	Strong network architecture Useful only if active-agent productivity improves.
University relationships	Long-standing B2B relationships and institutional scale support repeat business.	Universities can use direct recruitment, multiple platforms, or preferred-agent lists.	Moat with concentration risk Top university dependence must be monitored.
Technology and workflow	Application tracking, agent workflow, AI/product additions, and acquisition-led capability expansion.	Digital competitors can copy course-search and application workflows.	Useful, not enough alone Technology must show higher conversion and lower error rates.
Financial strength	27.1% EBITDA margin, positive FCF, near-zero debt, healthy cash balance.	Well-funded global platforms can spend aggressively on agent acquisition and university partnerships.	Financially resilient Low leverage gives room to absorb policy shocks.
Destination diversification	8 destination countries and management focus on redirecting demand across UK, Ireland, Germany, New Zealand and others.	Single-country agents are weaker here, but global platforms also diversify quickly.	Strategic positive Europe/UK split matters because policy risk is destination-specific.

Differentiation and Advantage Map

Each item is scored from public/company evidence available today.

QUESTION	ASSESSMENT	EVIDENCE	VERDICT
Product differentiation	Multi-sided B2B platform connecting agents and universities, not just a local counselling shop.	Large agent network, university partners, source-country breadth, destination breadth and application-processing scale.	Differentiated at scale
Superior quality	Potentially strong, but quality must be judged by conversion, visa success, refund/complaint data and collections.	Receivable days improved to 83.5 and FY26 revenue/enrolment improved to Rs 4.22L. However, analytical application-to-enrolment conversion fell to 6.3%.	Good signs, proof needed
Superior innovation of product/services	Moderate-positive. Product additions and AI can improve matching and counselling.	Management actions include EduMentor AI/product additions, B2C counselling expansion and new geographic capabilities.	Emerging advantage
Superior services - repair/replacement	For a services business, this means fixing documentation gaps, re-routing students, handling offer/visa issues and supporting pre-departure processes.	Public data does not disclose service-level metrics such as turnaround time, complaint rate or visa rework success.	Operationally important but not fully disclosed
Low-cost advantage	Asset-light model with low debt and low capex intensity is a cost advantage, but not proof of	D/E ~0.003x, FCF positive, capex modest relative to revenue, net working capital days near zero.	Capital-cost advantage

QUESTION	ASSESSMENT	EVIDENCE	VERDICT
	lowest commission pricing.		
Focus - particular product	Focused on international student mobility and recruitment infrastructure.	The core business remains student recruitment through agents and universities, with ancillary services around the same journey.	Focused adjacency
Value shop - problem solving	Yes. Crizac is trying to solve a complex matching and compliance problem between students, agents and universities.	Universities need genuine students; agents need program access; students need matching, documentation and visa readiness. Crizac sits in the middle.	Clear value-shop role

Strategic Read-Through

Fresh-purchase lens: what matters now, not IPO history alone.

Bull case

- High ROCE and very low leverage.
- Revenue and EBITDA growing faster than many traditional education-service businesses.
- Large agent/university network creates repeat flow.
- UK plus Europe and other destinations provide redirection options.

Base case

- Core platform remains a Star, while UK corridor behaves like a Cash Cow.
- Growth continues if conversion stabilises and revenue per enrolment remains healthy.
- AI/B2C/ancillary products are Question Marks until economics are visible.

Bear case

- Application growth outpaces genuine enrolments.
- University concentration or agent quality issues weaken trust.
- Policy tightening in UK/Canada/Australia hurts conversion.
- Receivables stretch despite reported revenue growth.

Final Company View

Current assessment after combining KPI strength and business-quality risks.

Crizac currently screens as a high-return, asset-light, low-debt growth platform. The best evidence is FY26 revenue of Rs 1,042.2 crore, EBITDA margin of 27.1%, ROCE of about 42.9%, debt/equity near zero, and positive free cash flow. The company is not just a generic counsellor; it is a multi-sided recruitment infrastructure business connecting agents, students and universities.

The key caveat is conversion quality. Applications and active agents grew sharply, but enrolment growth was much slower and inferred application-to-enrolment conversion weakened. For a fresh purchase today, the monitorables should be enrolments per active agent, revenue per enrolment, receivable days, university concentration, and whether Europe/other destinations genuinely diversify UK-led exposure.

Sources and Verification

Company filings, concall material, official site and exchange/public web checks only.

- Local company filings in workspace: **Quarter Report/Q4 FS.pdf**, **Quarter Report/IP Q4.pdf**, FY26 concall material and local FY26 financial compilation script.
- [NSE company quote page](#): current listed-company status and symbol CRIZAC checked on 03 July 2026.
- [Crizac official site](#): current official web presence checked on 03 July 2026.
- [Economic Times IPO report](#): public listing/IPO context cross-check.

Prepared as of 03 July 2026. Figures are FY26 unless stated otherwise. Derived ratios are approximate and based on company filing values available in the local research folder. This is not valuation or investment advice.

3. Financial Statement Dashboard

Crizac Limited - Financial Statement Dashboard

FY2022-FY2026 summary and FY2023-FY2026 statements | INR
crore unless stated otherwise

FY26 REVENUE

Rs 1,042.2 cr

22.7% YoY



EBITDA MARGIN

27.1%

Rs 282.4 cr EBITDA



PAT

Rs 219.2 cr

43.3% YoY | 20.5% margin



OPERATING CASH FLOW

Rs 144.1 cr

65.8% of PAT



ROE

37.2%

Recovered from 30.2%



CASH BALANCE

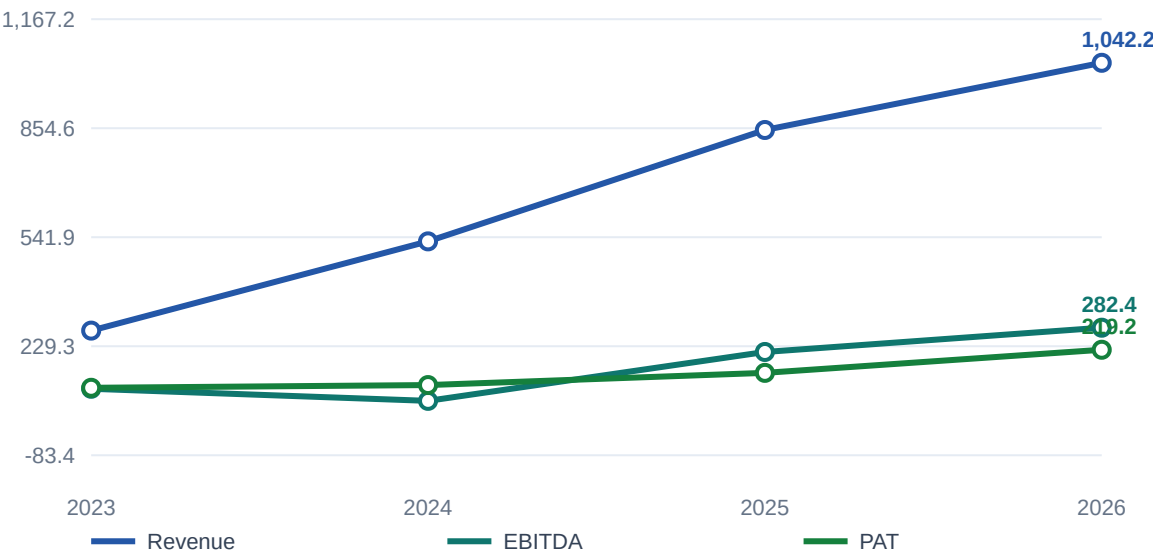
Rs 135.5 cr

1.7d net working capital



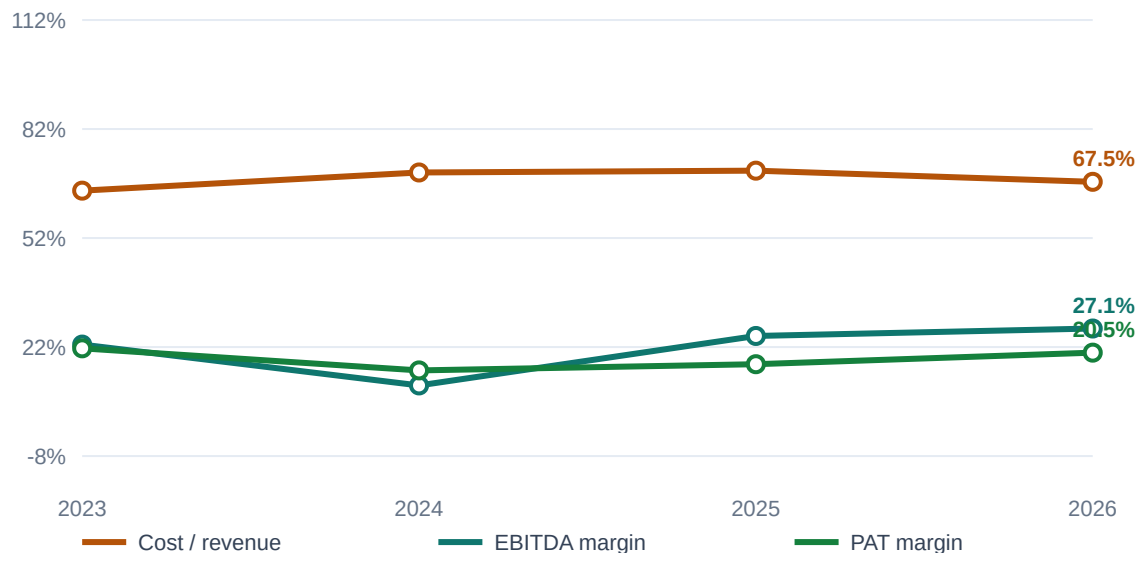
Operating Performance

Revenue, EBITDA and PAT



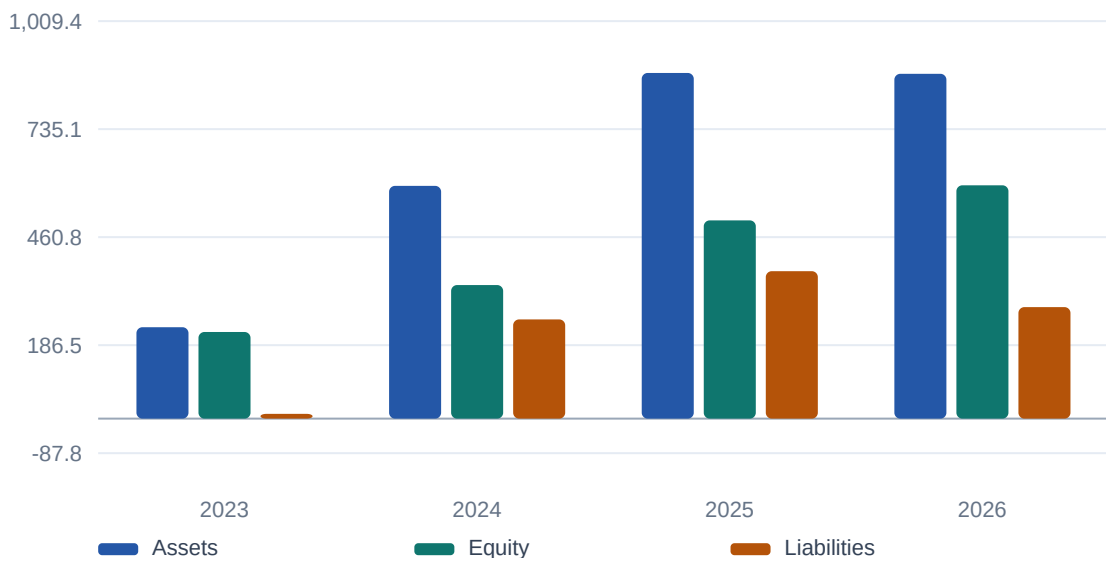
Margin Profile

Cost ratio, EBITDA margin and PAT margin



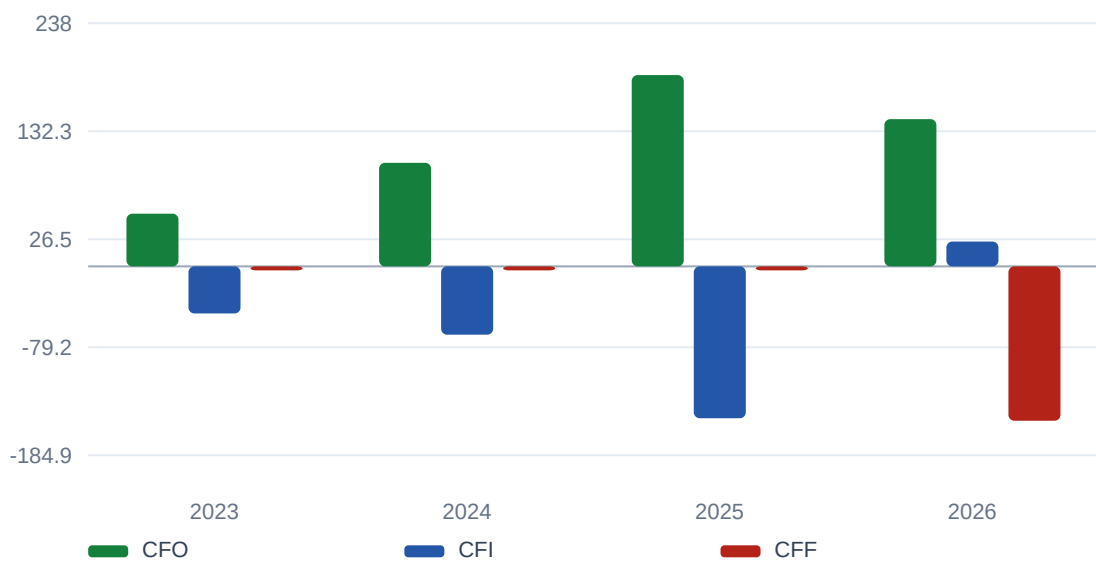
Balance Sheet Scale

Assets, equity and liabilities



Cash Flow Bridge

Operating, investing and financing cash flow



Particulars	Unit	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	Analysis
Revenue from operations	INR crore	Rs 263.5 cr	Rs 473 cr	Rs 634.9 cr	Rs 849.5 cr	Rs 1,042.2 cr	FY26 revenue up 22.7% YoY; five-year up remains strong.
YoY revenue growth	%	NA	79.5%	34.2%	33.8%	22.7%	FY26 growth slowed from FY25 but remained above 20%.
Cost of services	INR crore	NA	Rs 307.6 cr	Rs 444.6 cr	Rs 599.2 cr	Rs 703.2 cr	Cost ratio improved in FY26, expanding spread.
Cost of services / revenue	%	NA	65.0%	70.0%	70.5%	67.5%	FY26 ratio improved by about 300 bps versus FY25.
EBITDA	INR crore	NA	Rs 107.3 cr	Rs 72.6 cr	Rs 212.8 cr	Rs 282.4 cr	FY26 EBITDA up about 32.7% on the expanded workbook base.
EBITDA margin	%	NA	22.7%	11.4%	25.1%	27.1%	FY26 EBITDA margin expanded to 27.1% from 25.1%.
Profit after tax	INR crore	NA	Rs 112.1 cr	Rs 118.9 cr	Rs 152.9 cr	Rs 219.2 cr	PAT increased materially; PAT margin climbed to 20%.
PAT margin	%	NA	21.6%	15.6%	17.3%	20.5%	FY26 profitability improved on operating leverage.
ROE	%	NA	50.7%	34.8%	30.2%	37.2%	FY26 ROE recovered to 37.2% per investment presentation definition.
Net working capital days	days	NA	-20.0d	21.8d	-1.8d	1.7d	NWC days remained very low, indicating efficient conversion.
Student applications processed	count	NA	1,72,939	2,62,502	2,75,897	3,94,629	Applications processed grew 43.0% YoY in FY26.
Active agents	count	NA	1,819	2,532	3,948	5,389	Active agents grew 36.5% YoY in FY26.
Global institutions catered to	count	NA	111	124	173	198	Institution count increased, supporting product breadth.

FY2026 Read

Selected observations from the financial statement compilation

Growth

Revenue from operations reached Rs 1,042.16 crore, up 22.7% YoY, with applications and active agents both expanding strongly.

Margins

EBITDA margin expanded to 27.1%, helped by cost-of-services leverage versus FY2025.

Cash Generation

Operating cash flow remained positive at Rs 144.14 crore, but declined versus FY2025 on working-capital movements.

Balance Sheet

Total equity rose to Rs 592.44 crore while borrowings stayed negligible and cash ended at Rs 135.54 crore.

Working Capital

Net working capital days remained near zero at 1.72 days, reflecting efficient conversion discipline.

Watch Items

Goodwill and other current financial assets increased; note-level annual-report review remains important.

Source Register

Files used for the dashboard data

S1	DRHP.pdf	FY2021-FY2025 historical values and prospectus context
S2	Quarter Report/Q4 FS.pdf	FY2026 audited consolidated P&L, balance sheet and cash flow
S3	Quarter Report/IP Q4.pdf	FY2026 operating KPIs and management commentary

3.1 Narrative Financial Analysis

NARRATIVE FINANCIAL REVIEW

Crizac Limited - Narrative Financial Analysis

HIGHLIGHTED

FY2022-FY2026 financial summary | FY2023-FY2026 detailed statements | B2B international student recruitment platform | Rs crore

FY2026 audited Q4 incorporated

Narrative financial analysis

Two-page research format

FY26 REVENUE Rs 1,042.16 cr Up 22.7% YoY	FY26 EBITDA MARGIN 27.1% Scale did not dilute margin	FY26 PAT Rs 219.18 cr PAT margin about 20.5%	FY26 OCF Rs 144.14 cr Positive, but below FY25
--	--	--	--

Analyst read: Crizac looks like a high-growth, high-margin, low-leverage education-platform business. The quality test is whether application growth converts into durable enrolments, cash flow, and institution relationships without relying on IPO proceeds.

Company and Offer

OFS CONTEXT

Crizac Limited is a B2B education platform connecting agents with global institutions of higher education, offering international student recruitment solutions across the United Kingdom, Canada, Republic of Ireland, Australia and New Zealand. The UK route is the core strength, supported by long-standing institution relationships, a proprietary agent platform and a commission-led model tied to student applications and enrolments.

The July 2025 prospectus was a **pure offer for sale**: 35,102,040 equity shares of face value Rs 2 at Rs 245 per share, aggregating Rs 860.00 crore, sold by Pinky Agarwal and Manish Agarwal. There was **no fresh issue and the company did not receive IPO proceeds**. That matters for analysis: listing created liquidity and public-market access, but it did not recapitalise the business; FY2026 performance should therefore be judged on internal cash generation, working capital discipline and reinvestment capacity rather than IPO-funded expansion.

Key FY2026 Operating Markers

METRIC	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Applications processed	394,629	Large top-of-funnel expansion.
Active agents	5,389	Network scale increased.
Institutions catered to	198	Supports breadth of platform.
Net working capital days	1.72	Efficient operating cycle.

Earnings - Strong Growth With Operating Leverage

POSITIVE

Revenue from operations rose from Rs 263.53 crore in FY2022 to **Rs 1,042.16 crore** in FY2026, a roughly 41% CAGR over four annual steps. On the detailed statement base available from FY2023, revenue grew from Rs 274.10 crore to **Rs 1,042.16 crore**, with FY2026 up **22.7% year on year**. The operating drivers also expanded: **applications processed increased to 394,629, active agents to 5,389 and institutions catered to 198**.

The more important point is that scale did not dilute margins. Cost of services improved to 67.5% of revenue in FY2026 from 70.5% in FY2025, EBITDA rose to about Rs 282.4 crore and **EBITDA margin expanded to 27.1%**. **PAT reached Rs 219.18 crore**, PAT margin was about 20.5%, and EPS rose to Rs 12.52. Other income declined to Rs 28.96 crore, so the FY2026 earnings print was driven more by core operations than by treasury or incidental income. The only qualification is that employee cost and acquisition-linked items are now larger, so FY2027 margin stability will matter.

Financial Position - Asset-Light and Liquid

LOW LEVERAGE

The balance sheet is much cleaner than the typical working-capital-heavy IPO case. **Total assets were broadly flat at Rs 875.58 crore** in FY2026 versus Rs 877.74 crore in FY2025, while **total equity increased to Rs 592.44 crore** and total liabilities fell to Rs 283.13 crore. Borrowings were **negligible at roughly Rs 1.75 crore** including current and non-current borrowings, and **cash and cash equivalents rose to Rs 135.54 crore**.

The operating balance sheet improved in useful places: **trade receivables declined to Rs 238.51 crore despite higher revenue**, and current liabilities normalised as trade payables fell to Rs 233.59 crore. The watch items are asset composition rather than solvency. **Goodwill rose to Rs 24.36 crore**, PPE increased to Rs 32.22 crore, non-controlling interest appeared after acquisition activity, and **other current financial assets jumped to Rs 170.14 crore**. Those balances are not immediate red flags, but they require note-level review in the full annual report.

Cash Flow and Working Capital

MONITOR

Operating cash flow was positive at Rs 144.14 crore in FY2026, but **lower than Rs 187.27 crore in FY2025** despite a higher PBT of Rs 287.22 crore. The bridge explains the moderation: cash generated from operations was Rs 218.20 crore, tax paid was Rs 74.06 crore, receivables and other assets produced an inflow, but lower payables and liabilities created a Rs 115.46 crore outflow. This is **not an earnings-**

quality failure; it is a normalisation of creditor/liability funding after a strong prior-year cash conversion.

Free cash flow quality remains acceptable. Investing cash flow was positive Rs 24.29 crore because fixed-deposit maturities and interest receipts more than offset capex and acquisitions. Financing cash flow was negative Rs 151.11 crore, mainly because of a Rs 139.99 crore dividend and Rs 11.06 crore borrowing repayment. Ending cash still rose to Rs 135.54 crore after acquisition cash and foreign-exchange effects. **Net working capital days were only 1.72**, so the business remains efficient; the monitorable is whether FY2027 operating cash flow again tracks PAT more closely.

Crizac Limited - Returns, Peer Context and Monitorables

FY2026 incorporated from audited Q4 FY26 results and investor presentation

ROE

37.2%

Investor presentation basis

ROCE

48.6%

High-return platform profile

DEBT PROFILE

Near zero

Not lender-dependent

OFFER PRICE P/E

19.6x

Using FY26 EPS of Rs 12.52

Returns and DuPont

HIGH RETURN

Headline returns are genuinely strong: FY2026 **ROE was 37.2% and ROCE was 48.6%** as per the investor presentation. Unlike businesses where ROE is inflated by leverage, Crizac earns these returns with **almost no debt**. A simple DuPont read gives the shape: about a 20-21% net margin, roughly 1.2x asset turnover on average assets and only about 1.6x asset-to-equity leverage. Returns are therefore primarily a function of margin and capital-light operations, not financial engineering.

ROCE is the cleaner signal because it strips out capital-structure noise. At nearly 49%, it says the platform is generating high operating profit on the capital deployed. The sustainability test is not debt service; it is whether the company can keep institution relationships, agent productivity and admission volumes growing while preserving the commission spread after acquisitions and public-company costs.

Leverage, Coverage and Peers

CONTEXT

Leverage is effectively absent. Debt-to-equity is close to zero, the current ratio is about 2.1x, and finance cost was only Rs 0.07 crore, making conventional interest-cover ratios mathematically huge and not very informative. The practical takeaway is simpler: the company is **not dependent on lenders** to fund growth, dividends or working capital at the FY2026 balance-sheet date.

Peer benchmarking needs restraint. The prospectus itself notes there are **no exact listed peers** in India or internationally for Crizac's international student recruitment model; Indiamart Intermesh and IDP Education are only proxy peers. At the Rs 245 offer price, the prospectus FY2025 P/E was 28.0x versus a proxy peer average of 17.5x and highest of 27.2x. Using FY2026 EPS of Rs 12.52, the same offer price implies **roughly 19.6x earnings**, which looks more defensible, but the peer set remains imperfect. Valuation should therefore be underwritten from growth durability and cash conversion, not just peer multiples.

Investment Lens

AREA	SIGNAL	JUDGEMENT
Growth	Revenue CAGR and FY26 operating KPI expansion	STRONG
Margins	EBITDA margin at 27.1%	HEALTHY
Leverage	Borrowings around Rs 1.75 crore	LOW RISK
Cash flow	OCF positive but below FY25	MONITOR
Balance sheet notes	Goodwill and other current financial assets increased	REVIEW

Core Monitorables

- **Application-to-enrolment conversion** - confirms whether top-of-funnel scale is high quality.
- **Active-agent productivity** - proves whether new agents add real enrolments, not only applications.
- **Receivable/payable discipline** - protects cash conversion in a commission-led model.
- **Operating cash flow vs PAT** - validates earnings quality after FY2026 cash-flow moderation.
- Institution concentration, agent non-exclusivity, visa policy exposure and acquisition-linked balances.

Conclusion

HIGH-RETURN PLATFORM

Crizac screens as a **high-growth, high-margin, low-leverage education-platform business** with better cash quality than many IPO growth stories. The P&L is strong, ROCE is high, borrowings are negligible and FY2026 liquidity improved even after a large dividend. The business model is capital-light, and operating KPIs - applications, active agents and institutions - all moved in the right direction in FY2026.

The risks are concentrated but identifiable: dependence on a limited set of global institutions, reliance on non-exclusive agents, exposure to UK and overseas education/visa policy, data and compliance requirements, and the need to explain acquisition-linked goodwill plus the large other current financial asset balance. The case rests on four monitorables: **application-to-enrolment conversion, active-agent productivity, receivable/payable discipline, and whether operating cash flow keeps pace with PAT**. Net: Crizac is a credible high-return platform with strong FY2026 execution, but because the IPO was entirely OFS, the investment case should be built around **organic cash generation and relationship durability rather than fresh-capital deployment**.

4. Operational Excellence Assessment

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OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE ASSESSMENT

Crizac - Scaling Well, But Conversion Quality and Cash Discipline Need Proof

A number-backed assessment of whether Crizac growth is translating into quality enrolments, productive agents, better realisation per student, and disciplined cash conversion.

Prepared: 03 July 2026 Sources: DRHP + Q1-Q4 Concalls Scope: Conversion, Agents, Working Capital

Core Story in One Page

The top-of-funnel is scaling. The quality test is conversion, monetisation per enrolled student, and cash discipline.

FY26 APPLICATIONS

3.94L

+43% YoY

Top-of-funnel demand expanded strongly.

FY26 ENROLMENTS

24,697

+13.8% YoY

Grew slower than applications.

REVENUE / ENROLMENT

Rs 4.22L

+7.8% YoY

Improved from approx. Rs 3.91L in FY25.

ACTIVE AGENTS

5,389

+36.5% YoY

Agent network continues to scale.

FY26 RECEIVABLE DAYS

83.5

Improved vs 110.2

Company-method estimate from financial statements.

Operating narrative: Crizac is expanding the top of the funnel faster than the realised enrolment funnel. Applications grew **43%** and active agents grew **36.5%**, but enrolments grew **13.8%**. This is not automatically negative because applications are submitted **6-9 months** before intake and one student can apply to multiple institutions. Still, FY27 must prove that incremental applications and agents convert into quality enrolments.

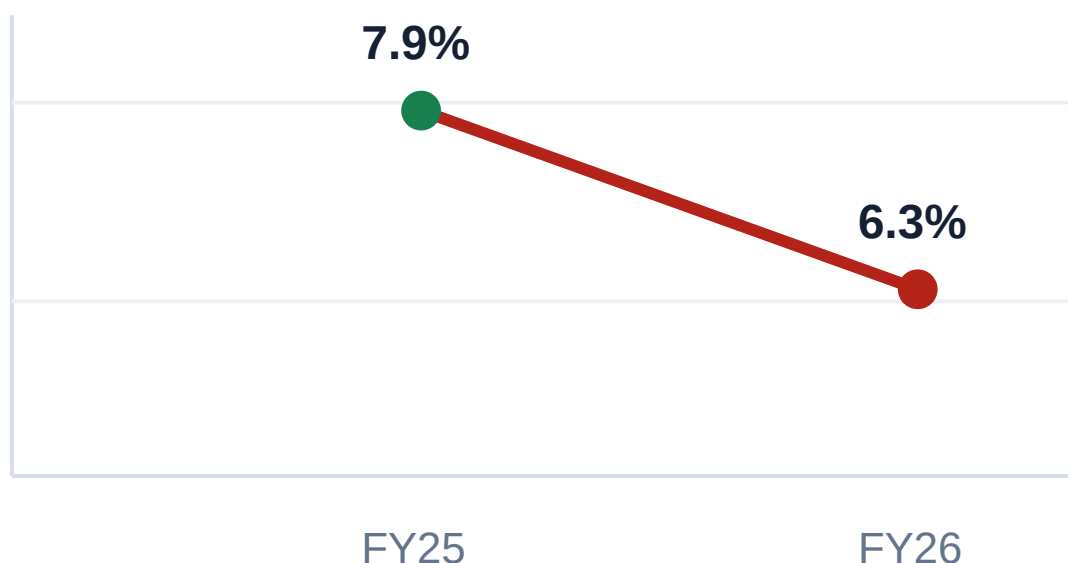
Monetisation and cash narrative: Revenue per enrolment improved from approx. **Rs 3.91L** to **Rs 4.22L**, partly offsetting weaker funnel conversion. On cash discipline, the detailed company-method view shows FY26 receivable days improving to **83.5** and net working capital days near zero at **1.7**,.

Selected KPI Trends

Only the clearest charts are retained. Detailed numbers are kept in tables below.

Conversion Ratio

Analytical enrolments / applications.



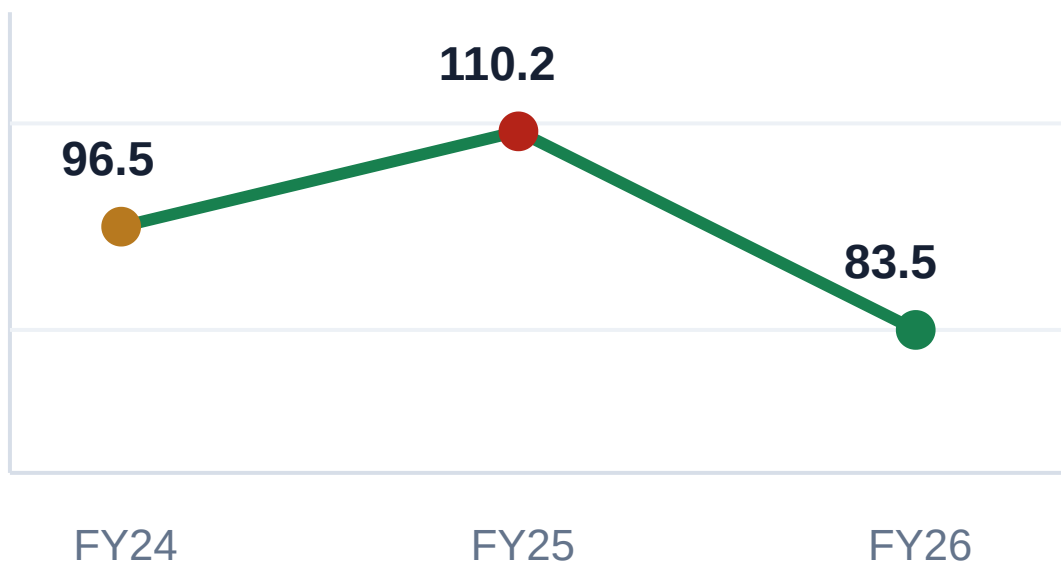
Revenue / Enrolment

Approximate realisation per enrolled student.



Receivable Days

Company-method estimate.



Data Caveats Before Reading

Important context for interpreting the KPIs correctly.

ISSUE	WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN	HOW TO READ IT
Applications are not unique students	Q1 concall clarified that one student may apply to two or three institutions.	Application-to-enrolment ratio is an analytical funnel ratio, not management's unique-student conversion rate.
Applications lead enrolments	Applications may be processed 6-9 months ahead of intake; Q3 applications convert into Q4 enrolments/revenue.	Do not compare application growth and same-period enrolment growth mechanically.
Working-capital methodology	The report uses trade receivables, trade payables and cost-of-services mechanics from company documents.	Company-method NWC shows the operating-cycle offset from agent payables.

1. Application Conversion

Application growth is strong, but enrolment conversion is the real quality test.

METRIC	FY24	FY25	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Applications processed	262,502	275,897	394,000+	FY26 application growth was strong at about 43% YoY.
Student enrolments	NA	~21,702	24,697	FY25 inferred from FY26 enrolments and 13.8% YoY growth.
Application-to-enrolment ratio	NA	7.9%	6.3%	Analytical funnel ratio weakened by 1.6 pp .
Management source-market conversion	NA	NA	India ~10%; China/LATAM ~20%; Africa ~5%	Mix matters. Geographic expansion can dilute or improve blended conversion.

Strong

- 3.94 lakh FY26 applications.

- 43% application growth.

Watch

- Enrolment growth was only 13.8%.
- Analytical conversion declined.

Risk

- More applications can create noise if they do not become genuine students.

2. Revenue Per Enrolment

Monetisation per enrolled student partly offsets weaker conversion.

METRIC	FY24	FY25	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Revenue from operations	Rs 6,348.66m	Rs 8,494.91m	Rs 10,422m	FY26 revenue grew 22.7% YoY.
Student enrolments	NA	~21,702	24,697	FY25 inferred; FY24 enrolments not available in local source set.
Revenue per enrolment	NA	Rs 3.91L	Rs 4.22L	Approximate realisation per enrolled student improved by about 7.8%.

Read-through: FY26 conversion weakened, but revenue per enrolment improved from approx. **Rs 3.91L** to **Rs 4.22L**. This is positive only if sustainable and not accompanied by slower collections.

3. Active-Agent Productivity

Agent addition is healthy; agent-to-enrolment productivity is the next proof point.

METRIC	FY24	FY25	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Registered / broader platform agents	6,509	10,362	15,000+	Network scale increased materially.
Active agents	2,532	3,948	5,389	FY26 active agents grew 36.5% YoY.
Applications per active agent	103.7	69.9	73.2	FY26 recovered modestly after FY25 dilution.

METRIC	FY24	FY25	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Enrolments per active agent	NA	5.5	4.6	Weakened despite active-agent growth.
Top 10 agents revenue share	14.80%	9.93%	NA	FY25 sourcing concentration was low, a positive network-quality marker.

Agent Network Strengths

- Active agents increased from 2,532 in FY24 to 5,389 in FY26.
- Top 10 agents contributed only 9.93% of FY25 revenue.

Productivity Watch Items

- Applications per active agent recovered only modestly.
- Enrolments per active agent fell from 5.5 to 4.6.

4. Receivable / Payable Discipline

The operating model has a natural payable offset, but external ratio flags still deserve attention.

METRIC	FY24	FY25	FY26	READ-THROUGH
Trade receivables	167.9	256.4	238.5	FY26 receivables reduced despite business growth.
Trade payables	130.1	260.6	233.6	Payables move with receivables because agent payout follows university collection.
Receivable days	96.5	110.2	83.5	FY26 improved materially from FY25.
Payable days on cost of services	106.8	158.7	121.2	Payables normalised but remained higher than receivable days.
Net working capital days	21.7	-1.8	1.7	Near-zero NWC days indicate a capital-light operating cycle.
Operating cash flow to EBITDA	NA	NA	56%	Q4 call says moderated by about Rs 55 crore one-off termination fee.

Supports Discipline

- Agent payout follows university collection.

- NWC days near zero in FY26.

Needs Proof

- Management says working capital improved due better organisation.
- Need proof in future ageing and cash flow.

Risk

- Collections should be monitored through receivable ageing and operating cash conversion.
- University concentration creates collection dependency.

5. Customer Stickiness and Network Quality

Customer satisfaction is inferred from repeat relationships, new institution additions and agent continuity.

INDICATOR	NUMBER / EVIDENCE	INTERPRETATION
University relationship tenure	More than 20 of top 30 global institutions had relationships of over 5 years.	Strong repeat-business proxy Universities appear to trust Crizac's funnel.
Top university concentration	Top 10 university partners accounted for 66% of revenue.	Moat and risk together Deep relationships, but high dependency.
FY25 institution additions	Added: UK 19, Canada 5, Ireland 0, Others 36. Lost: UK 0, Canada 3, Ireland 1, Others 7.	Net addition positive Supports destination and course expansion.
Agent stickiness	Active agents rose from 3,948 to 5,389 in FY26; management says older agents continue.	Positive retention signal Productivity per agent remains the proof point.

6. Learning, Innovation and Internal Business Quality

Whether scale is making the company better, not just bigger.

Process Innovation

- Agents upload student details, documents and preferences.
- Crizac assesses eligibility against university criteria.

- Agents get real-time deadline and admission requirement updates.

Product Initiatives

- EduMentor AI for matching and mentorship.
- Global Tree for B2C counselling and immigration services.
- ForeignAdmits/Edument investment and Nikhil Jain as Chief Product & Marketing Officer.

People Scalability

- Employees grew from 28 to 368 between Apr 2022 and Mar 2025.
- Attrition: FY23 46.73%, FY24 20.67%, FY25 28.74%.

Balanced Scorecard

Summary across conversion, productivity and cash discipline.

Customer Satisfaction

Moderate-positive

Demand and customer stickiness are positive, but FY26 analytical conversion fell from **7.9%** to **6.3%**.

Learning / Innovation / Growth

Improving, not proven

AI, platform workflow and B2C/product additions help, but agent-to-enrolment productivity weakened from **5.5** to **4.6**.

Internal Business Quality

Strong architecture, cash watch

Network architecture is strong; receivable/payable offset is useful, but external WC flags remain important.

Final Combined View

Number-backed operating conclusion.

What Is Working

- Applications: 3.94 lakh in FY26, up 43% YoY.
- Revenue per enrolment improved to Rs 4.22L.
- Active agents: 5,389 in FY26, up 36.5% YoY.
- Receivable days improved from 110.2 to 83.5.

What Is Not Yet Proven

- FY26 enrolments grew 13.8%, much slower than applications.
- Analytical conversion fell from 7.9% to 6.3%.
- Enrolments per active agent declined from 5.5 to 4.6.

What Can Hurt The Thesis

- Top 10 university partners account for 66% of revenue.
- Agents are non-exclusive and can shift volumes elsewhere.

Bottom line: Crizac's operating engine is scaling, but quality must be measured through conversion and cash, not only application volume. The positive story is a large agent network, sticky university relationships, improving revenue per enrolment and a near-zero working-capital cycle. The caution is that applications grew far faster than enrolments, agent-to-enrolment productivity weakened,.

FY27 Monitorables

The numbers that should decide whether the operating story is improving.

MONITORABLE	GOOD SIGNAL	WEAK SIGNAL
Application-to-enrolment ratio	Improves from 6.3%	Continues declining despite applicat
Revenue per enrolment	Stays near or above Rs 4.22L without receivable stretch	Falls or improves only with slower c
Enrolments per active agent	Improves from 4.6 toward FY25's 5.5	New agents add applications but not
Receivable days	Stays near 83.5 or better	Receivables expand faster than reve

MONITORABLE		GOOD SIGNAL	WEAK SIGNAL
Net working capital days		Remains near zero	Cash conversion weakens despite n

Sources Combined

Combined from the two existing HTML reports plus their underlying documents.

- **1. Operational Quality - Conversion Agent Receivable Discipline.html:** customer satisfaction, innovation, internal business perspective, strategic assets and agent stickiness.
- **2. Conversion_Productivity_WorkingCapital_Analysis_With_Concalls.html:** application conversion, active-agent productivity, receivable/payable discipline and concall overlays.
- Local DRHP/prospectus and Q1-Q4 FY26 concalls.

Prepared as of 03 July 2026. Scope: operational quality, application conversion, revenue per enrolment, agent productivity and receivable/payable discipline. This is not valuation or investment advice.

5. Promoter & Management Analysis

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PROMOTER AND MANAGEMENT ONLY

Crizac Limited - Promoter and Management Analysis

This report is limited to promoter, board, key managerial personnel, senior management, control, governance conduct, and management continuity. It intentionally excludes valuation, price, financial statement performance, working capital, and business projections.

Current Verification: 03 July 2026

NSE: CRIZAC

BSE: 544439

Scope: Promoter & Management

Scope discipline: This file analyses only promoter and management quality. Historical information is included only where it explains the present promoter-control structure, management incentives, governance risk, or continuity of leadership.

Current View

Public web verification checked on 03 July 2026, combined with company offer-document and concall material.

Promoter and management assessment: Crizac remains a promoter-controlled, founder-led company. The operator quality appears strong because the key promoters are deeply involved in strategy, finance, and institutional relationships. Governance comfort is moderate, not high, because promoter and promoter-group holding remains very high and the listed-company governance track record is still developing.

Current conclusion: Promoter/management quality is a strength for execution but a watch item for minority shareholders. The main issue is not capability; it is dependence on promoter conduct, related-party discipline, independent board effectiveness, and management depth beyond the promoter family.

Promoter capability



Strong

Management depth



Improving

Governance risk



Medium-High

Current Public Verification

Only promoter and management related public facts are shown here.

PROMOTER HOLDING

79.94%

Latest visible Mar 2026 shareholding pattern on public market data.

LISTING IDENTITY

CRIZAC

Listed company status verified via NSE and BSE identifiers.

LATEST MANAGEMENT UPDATE FOUND

15 Jun 2026

Nikhil Jain announced to join as Chief Product and Marketing Officer.

ITEM VERIFIED	PRESENT STATUS	MANAGEMENT / GOVERNANCE IMPLICATION
Promoter control	Promoter and promoter-group holding remains visible at 79.94% for Mar 2026.	High alignment with shareholders, but also high control over board appointments and strategic decisions.
Exchange identity	Crizac is publicly identifiable as NSE: CRIZAC and BSE: 544439.	Future promoter/management changes should be tracked through BSE/NSE filings.
Recent senior-management addition	June 15, 2026 BSE/NSE press release states that ForeignAdmits founder Nikhil Jain will join as Chief Product and Marketing Officer.	Positive sign of professionalisation and product/technology strengthening; integration and actual operating influence should be monitored.
Current board-change check	Public web check did not surface a newer board-change filing that contradicted the DRHP/prospectus board composition.	The board analysis below uses the latest detailed disclosed composition available in the research file, with current filing checks required for any later change.

Promoter Analysis

Current relevance of each promoter for control, execution, and governance.

PROMOTER	CURRENT ROLE / RELEVANCE	ASSESSMENT
Dr. Vikash Agarwal	Chairman and Managing Director. Founder/operator profile with deep involvement in strategy and institutional relationships.	Core execution strength. Also creates key-person dependence because the business relies on promoter relationships with institutions and agents.
Manish Agarwal	Whole-Time Director and CFO. Promoter with finance responsibility and long association with the company.	Positive that finance is led by a long-tenured promoter with professional accounting background. Investor comfort depends on transparent disclosure and related-party discipline.
Pinky Agarwal	Promoter and Non-Executive Director. Large shareholder and part of promoter family control.	Important for ownership alignment and control. Historical share sale through OFS should be treated as promoter monetisation context, not as a standalone negative today.
Promoter group	Promoter and promoter-group ownership remains high at 79.94% in latest visible public shareholding.	Control remains concentrated. Minority shareholders must rely on board independence, disclosure quality, and clean related-party governance.

Board and Governance

Governance analysis is included because it directly reflects promoter and management quality.

DIRECTOR	ROLE	CATEGORY	GOVERNANCE READING
Dr. Vikash Agarwal	Chairman and Managing Director	Executive Promoter	Central operator and strategic decision-maker.
Manish Agarwal	Whole-Time Director and CFO	Executive Promoter	Promoter-led finance function; important for transparency and control discipline.
Pinky Agarwal	Non-Executive Director	Promoter	Adds promoter presence on board beyond executive promoters.
Rakesh Kumar Agrawal	Independent Director	Independent	Financial/audit background. Audit committee role is important because promoter control is high.
Anuj Saraswat	Independent Director	Independent	Corporate governance and secretarial background. Useful for listed-company compliance.
Payal Bafna	Independent Director	Independent	Independent woman director with company-secretarial and law background.

Governance positives

- Board structure includes three independent directors.
- Independent woman director is present.
- Audit, nomination/remuneration, stakeholder, CSR, risk management, and IPO committees were disclosed.

Governance watch items

- Promoter family influence remains high.
- Listed-company governance track record is still developing.
- Independent director effectiveness needs to be judged through actual decisions and disclosures.

Governance risks

- High promoter control can limit minority-shareholder influence.
- Related-party transactions need strict monitoring.

- Key-person dependence on promoters remains material.

Key Managerial Personnel and Senior Management

This section covers only people and management depth, not financial performance.

PERSON	CURRENT / DISCLOSED ROLE	MANAGEMENT-QUALITY READING
Kashish Arora	Company Secretary and Compliance Officer.	Important for listed-company compliance, governance filings, and board process discipline.
Priya Fulfagar	Chief Operating Officer.	Provides operational management layer beyond promoters.
Salaria Zaheer	Chief Marketing Officer.	Relevant for agent, student, and institutional outreach.
Sibendu Roy	Chief Technology Officer.	Long-tenured technology leadership supports platform continuity.
Anindita Das	Chief Business Officer.	Business-development continuity and execution support.
Christopher Flood Nagle	CEO, Crizac UK.	Strategically important for international education-market leadership and UK operations.
Nikhil Jain	Announced on June 15, 2026 to join as Chief Product and Marketing Officer after Crizac's ForeignAdmits/Edument investment.	Current positive addition to product and marketing capability. Actual contribution should be monitored after onboarding and integration.

Historical Context Relevant Today

Only promoter and management history that affects current assessment is included.

2011 onward

Crizac was built as a promoter-led platform. The long operating history of Dr. Vikash Agarwal, Manish Agarwal, and Pinky Agarwal is relevant because the present business still depends on management relationships and execution.

Pre-listing

Promoters and promoter group held 100% before the public issue. This explains why promoter influence remains structurally high even after listing.

Post-listing

Latest visible Mar 2026 public shareholding still shows promoter and promoter-group holding at 79.94%. The company continues to be promoter-controlled.

Jun 2026

The Nikhil Jain addition through the ForeignAdmits transaction indicates an attempt to deepen professional/product capability beyond the original promoter-led structure.

Promoter and Management Positives

Strengths limited to people, control, governance, and leadership.

Strengths

- Promoters remain deeply involved and materially invested.
- Founder-led execution gives continuity in a relationship-driven business.
- Finance function is led by a promoter with professional accounting background.
- Second-line leadership is visible across operations, marketing, technology, business, compliance, and UK operations.
- Nikhil Jain addition suggests management is broadening into product-led capability.

Constructive governance signals

- Independent directors and key committees are disclosed.
- Company Secretary/Compliance Officer role is identified.
- No newer public source checked showed a contradictory board-change filing.
- Q4 FY26 management call showed willingness to discuss business operations and uncertainty.

Promoter and Management Risks

Risks limited to leadership, control, governance, and conduct.

Key risks

- Promoter and promoter-group holding of 79.94% gives very high control.
- Dr. Vikash Agarwal and Manish Agarwal are central to operations, relationships, and decisions, creating key-person risk.
- Promoter family relationships increase the need for strong independent oversight.
- Related-party transactions, including promoter-group office lease disclosures, require ongoing monitoring.
- Listed-company governance behavior is still new and must be proven over time.

Monitorables

- Any further promoter share sale, pledge, or change in promoter holding.
- Independent director resignations, appointments, or committee changes.
- Related-party transaction values and approval quality.
- Senior management turnover, especially COO, CTO, UK CEO, CS, and Nikhil Jain.
- Evidence that professional managers have real operating responsibility, not only titles.

Final Promoter and Management View

This is the only conclusion in this file; valuation and financials are outside scope.

Current promoter/management verdict: Crizac's promoter and management setup is execution-positive but governance-sensitive. The promoters appear capable, experienced, and highly aligned through large retained ownership. The company also shows signs of professionalisation through senior functional leadership and the recent Nikhil Jain addition.

The concern is control concentration. With promoter and promoter-group holding still visible at 79.94%, minority shareholders depend heavily on promoter conduct, independent-director effectiveness, related-party discipline, and transparent exchange disclosures. For any current investor, the promoter/management profile should be treated as **strong on capability, moderate on governance comfort, and medium-high on control risk**.

Sources Checked

Sources are included only for promoter and management verification.

- [Screener - Crizac Ltd](#): latest visible promoter shareholding and public company identifiers.
- [NSE - CRIZAC quote page](#): listed-company identity and filing navigation.
- [BSE/NSE press-release filing dated 15 June 2026](#): ForeignAdmits investment and Nikhil Jain Chief Product and Marketing Officer update.
- Local research folder: Crizac DRHP/prospectus and Q4 FY26 investor concall transcript for board, promoter, KMP, and senior-management disclosures.

Prepared as of 03 July 2026. Scope is limited to promoter and management analysis only.

6. Issues and Red Flags

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KEY RISKS, CONCERNS & WATCHPOINTS

Crizac Limited - Business Risks, Regulatory Developments & Monitorables

Prepared from Q1-Q4 FY26 concall transcripts in the local folder, with external checks from UK, Canada, Australia and global student-mobility policy sources. This is a risk-screening document, not a valuation call.

DESTINATION CONCENTRATION

~97%

UK mix mentioned in Q4 analyst Q&A, with management targeting below 60% over two years.

FY26 APPLICATION GROWTH

43%

Applications grew much faster than student enrolments, weakening the KPI quality.

FY26 ENROLMENT GROWTH

14%

Lower conversion into enrolled students is the most important operating-quality issue.

FY26 CFO / EBITDA

56%

Management says this was moderated by a Rs 55 crore termination-fee payment.

Core Verdict

The company is reporting growth, profitability and a debt-free balance sheet, but the concalls reveal a business still heavily exposed to policy, visa, currency and conversion risks. The biggest issue is not whether demand for overseas education exists; it is whether Crizac can diversify away from the UK without sacrificing conversion quality, margins and cash conversion.

The red flags are most relevant for valuation multiples. A business with 97% destination exposure, non-exclusive platform relationships and conversion sensitivity should not be valued as a clean, diversified,

high-moat platform unless the next few quarters prove otherwise.

What Would Change The View

- UK revenue contribution falling quarter by quarter without a margin reset.
- Enrolment growth moving closer to application growth.
- CFO / EBITDA sustainably above 80% after normal working-capital swings.
- Clear organic versus acquisition growth split.
- Stable FY27 guidance with explicit country and conversion assumptions.

Red Flags - Detailed Assessment

1. Extreme UK Destination Concentration

HIGH

Q4 Q&A states that the UK destination mix is around 97%. Management agrees concentration has to come down and says it prefers UK contribution below 60% within two years. That is a very large promised mix shift and execution risk is high.

Concall evidence: Q4 discussion around UK at ~97%, target below 60%, rest of world around 40%, dependent on Australia, Canada and US opening up.

External context: the UK government white paper tightens student sponsor compliance and graduate-stay conditions, which matters directly when one destination dominates revenue. See GOV.UK immigration white paper, student-route reforms and BCA thresholds.

2. Visa And Sponsor Compliance Risk Is Real

HIGH

Management presents UK policy as manageable and says Crizac's visa-refusal rate is well below the UKVI threshold. The external policy backdrop is still tightening. UK BCA sponsor metrics are moving up by five percentage points: course enrolment from at least 90% to 95%, completion from 85% to 90%, and a new intervention/banding regime is planned.

Concall evidence: Q3 discussion says the visa-refusal threshold changed from 10% to 5%, and Crizac is "way below" that threshold. Analysts also asked about UK rules getting stricter.

Why it matters: if any key partner university enters an action-plan or recruitment-limit regime, Crizac's high concentration makes the impact potentially disproportionate.

3. Applications Are Not Translating Cleanly Into Enrolments

HIGH

FY26 application processing grew 43% year-on-year, but student enrolments grew only 14%. Management explains this through geography mix: India around 10% conversion, Africa around 5%, China and Latin

America around 20%. This explanation is plausible, but it means headline application growth is a weak KPI unless conversion and revenue per enrolled student are disclosed consistently.

Concall evidence: Q4 Q&A directly asks why applications grew 43% while enrolments grew 14%; management cites geographic mix and says total conversion was 14%.

Investor implication: revenue growth can decelerate even when processed applications look strong, especially if marginal growth comes from lower-conversion source markets.

4. Enrolment Disclosure Was Initially Weak

MEDIUM

In earlier FY26 calls, management resisted giving enrolled-student numbers, calling them sensitive. Q4 disclosure improved, but important splits are still missing: organic versus acquired growth, mature-agent wallet share, country-level enrolment conversion and revenue per enrolled student.

Concall evidence: Q1 says enrolment numbers are not disclosed; Q3 says applications are usually disclosed to show seasonality; Q4 gives enrolment growth but cannot quantify existing-agent versus new-agent growth.

Why it matters: for an intermediary/platform business, enrolments and conversion are closer to economic reality than application count.

5. Cash Conversion Needs Follow-Up

MEDIUM

Q2 operating cash flow was negative, with analysts flagging large movements in trade payables and other financial liabilities. Management attributed this to delayed university receipts and said agent payouts happen after university collection. In Q4, FY26 operating cash flow was only 56% of EBITDA, before adjusting for a Rs 55 crore termination-fee payment.

Concall evidence: Q2 references negative cash flow, trade payables around Rs 95 crore and other financial liabilities around Rs 56 crore. CFO did not have full cash-flow details handy for follow-up questions.

Investor implication: the business may be profitable, but the receivable/payable cycle needs quarter-wise monitoring because revenue recognition depends on university confirmation and payment follows later.

6. Platform Moat Is Not Contractually Strong

MEDIUM

Management describes network effects and institutional relationships, but Q2 says there is no exclusivity with either universities or agents. Q3 says most universities work with multiple platforms. The moat is service quality and relationship history, not lock-in.

Concall evidence: Q2 says no exclusivity with universities or agents; Q3 confirms most universities use multiple platforms.

External context: the UK white paper's Agent Quality Framework requirement may favour compliant players, but it can also increase compliance cost and formalize scrutiny of agent-led recruitment.

7. Margins Are Less Scalable Than The Platform Label Suggests

MEDIUM

Management clarified that cost of services rises broadly with revenue because commissions to channel partners are the major expense. Sustainable EBITDA margin was discussed around 24-25%. Q4 gross-margin improvement was attributed substantially to FX movement, not a permanent change in take-rate economics.

Concall evidence: Q2 says the business should not be compared with high-operating-leverage consumer platforms; Q4 says gross-margin improvement was mainly due to GBP/INR movement.

Investor implication: valuation should reflect a commission-intermediation model with partial operating leverage, not pure software-like economics.

8. Diversification Is Becoming Acquisition-Led

MEDIUM

FY26 included StudiesPlanet, Global Tree, EduMentor and Medway/New Zealand initiatives. These may be strategically useful, but the number of moving parts increases integration risk and makes it harder to separate organic growth from acquired capability.

Concall evidence: Q4 describes acquisitions and investments across LATAM sourcing, B2C counselling/immigration, AI matching and New Zealand on-ground capability.

Investor implication: demand a clean acquisition bridge: purchase consideration, revenue, EBITDA, working capital, integration cost and retention of key people.

9. FY27 Guidance Was Deferred

MEDIUM

Earlier FY26 calls were comfortable talking about 20-25% or 25-30% growth. In Q4, management and IR deferred firm FY27 guidance, citing geopolitics, student flow, conversion and revenue-profile visibility. That tone change deserves attention.

Concall evidence: Q4 says firm guidance will be provided when visibility improves and that it is difficult to give guidance at this stage.

Investor implication: if management cannot guide despite a supposedly predictable intake cycle, the policy and destination-mix uncertainty is material.

10. Reporting Quality And Preparedness Issues

WATCH

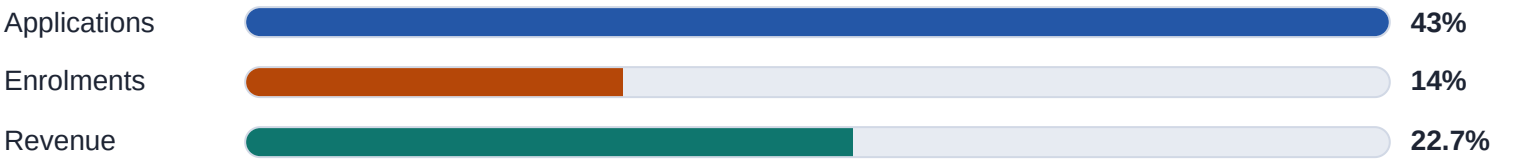
Q2 included an analyst flagging inconsistencies across investor-presentation slides. Management acknowledged a mistake and said revised slides would be uploaded. Separately, the CFO did not have details handy for certain cash-flow and subsidiary questions.

Concall evidence: Q2 slide totals were incorrect; Q2 cash-flow follow-up questions were deferred; Q3 subsidiary details for Ucall were not immediately available.

Investor implication: not a fraud signal by itself, but a newly listed company with complex cross-border operations needs tight reporting discipline.

Operating KPI Quality

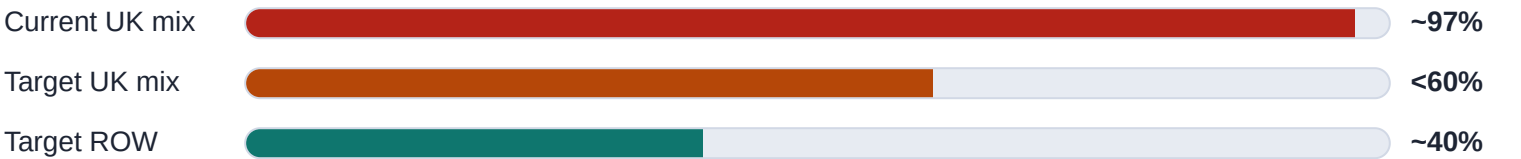
The key point is that applications are an input metric, while enrolments are the monetisation metric. The FY26 gap suggests that either the source mix is changing, application quality is weakening, or the conversion cycle is longer than headline commentary implies.



Bars are scaled to the application growth rate. Source: Q4 FY26 concall management commentary.

Destination Concentration Path

The target mix shift is ambitious. Reducing UK from around 97% to below 60% requires rapid growth outside the UK, but the main alternative markets are also policy-sensitive.



Source: Q4 FY26 concall Q&A. ROW means rest of world.

External Policy Triangulation

External development	Source evidence	Relevance to Crizac
UK is tightening student-route compliance.	GOV.UK says BCA sponsor metrics include visa refusal, enrolment and completion thresholds, and the government will raise BCA pass requirements by five percentage points.	High UK concentration means tighter sponsor compliance can affect Crizac through partner universities even if Crizac itself has strong internal screening.
UK Graduate route duration reduced to	GOV.UK white paper says graduates' ability to remain in the UK after studies will be reduced to	Post-study work attractiveness is a major student decision variable. Management

External development	Source evidence	Relevance to Crizac
18 months.	18 months.	argues this is baked in; the risk is that student demand and conversion still soften over time.
Canada capped study permits and tightened PGWP eligibility.	IRCC announced a 2024 cap expected to result in about 360,000 approved study permits, then a 2025 cap of 437,000, along with PGWP and spouse-work-permit restrictions.	Canada is one of the diversification markets management discusses. Policy caps limit the speed at which Canada can offset UK concentration.
Australia is using a managed growth system.	Australia's Department of Education says the 2026 National Planning Level is 295,000 and ministerial direction will continue to support a managed system.	Australia is a potential growth driver, but entry is not unconstrained. Provider allocations, visa processing and housing-linked priorities can affect conversion.
US student visa process became more uncertain in 2025.	AP reported a pause in new student visa interview scheduling while the US expanded social-media screening for student and exchange visitor applicants.	US is a large market and part of Crizac's diversification story, but visa friction can delay the ramp-up and make near-term guidance harder.
Agent-led recruitment is under scrutiny.	GOV.UK white paper requires sponsors using overseas recruitment agents to sign up to the Agent Quality Framework; media investigations have highlighted agent-incentive and mis-selling concerns in UK recruitment.	Crizac's model depends on agent networks. Strong compliance can be an advantage, but higher scrutiny raises execution, monitoring and reputational risk.

Quarterly Monitoring Checklist

Metric / question	Why it matters	Red-flag trigger
UK destination revenue mix	Tests whether diversification is actually happening.	UK remains above 90% after two more quarters, or non-UK growth is mainly acquisition-led.
Applications versus enrolments	Separates activity from monetisation.	Application growth stays above 30% but enrolment growth remains below 15%.
Country-wise conversion	Source-market mix can dilute conversion.	Growth shifts toward lower-conversion geographies without revenue-per-student uplift.
Receivables, payables and CFO / EBITDA	Tests quality of earnings and university payment cycle.	CFO / EBITDA below 70% for another year, excluding clearly one-off items.
Gross margin and EBITDA margin	Tests platform operating leverage claims.	Margin improvement explained by FX or bonus income rather than structural take-rate gains.
Acquisition contribution bridge	Separates organic growth from purchased growth.	No clear revenue/EBITDA split for StudiesPlanet, Global Tree, EduMentor and Medway initiatives.

Metric / question	Why it matters	Red-flag trigger
FY27 guidance	Tests management visibility.	Guidance remains deferred or is given without country, conversion and policy assumptions.

Source Register

Local concall sources

- Quarter Report / Concall Q1.pdf - Q1 FY26 result update call, August 5, 2025.
- Quarter Report / Concall Q2.pdf - Q2 FY26 earnings call, October 16, 2025.
- Quarter Report / Concall Q3.pdf - Q3 FY26 results update call, January 28, 2026.
- Quarter Report / Concall Q4.pdf - Q4 FY26 earnings call, May 25, 2026.

External sources used

- [GOV.UK - Restoring control over the immigration system, accessible white paper](#) - UK student-route, BCA, Agent Quality Framework and Graduate-route changes.
- [IRCC - Canada to stabilize growth and decrease new international student permits](#) - 2024 study-permit cap and PGWP changes.
- [IRCC - Strengthening temporary residence programs for sustainable volumes](#) - 2025 cap, PGWP and spouse-work-permit restrictions.
- [Australian Department of Education - A managed system for international education](#) - 2026 National Planning Level and managed-growth framework.
- [Associated Press - US stops scheduling visa interviews for foreign students while it expands social media vetting](#) - US visa-processing uncertainty.
- [The Guardian - UK universities paying millions in agent fees to secure international students](#) - external context on agent incentives and scrutiny.
- [The Guardian - The brutal reality of life as a foreign student in the UK](#) - external context on mis-selling and agent-led recruitment risks.

This report intentionally prioritizes primary government sources for policy claims. Media sources are used only for market-practice context around recruitment agents and US visa-processing disruption.